FILL THE AUCTION ROOM.

Performance Marketing Manager · Your assignment: turn ad spend into registered, active bidders.

At Vihara, we auction bank-owned (REO) properties on behalf of banks and servicers at vihara.ai. Our buyers range from flippers and buy-and-hold landlords to first-time investors, portfolio buyers, and owner-occupants.

You join us as Performance Marketing Manager tomorrow. Your job is to fill our auction rooms with qualified, registered bidders, and to do it cheaper every month.

Don't give us a marketing textbook. Show us what you'd actually do, and what you'd actually make.

WHY	WHAT	HOW
Sign-ups are easy. Registered bidders are the job.	A diagnosis, one campaign with real creatives, testing rules, a referral program, your AI workflow, and a 30-day plan.	8 to 10 slides plus a 5-minute Loom, submitted via our form within 72 hours. Plan for 5 to 6 focused hours.

PART 1

Diagnose the leak 1 slide

Scenario (numbers are illustrative). A property auction campaign runs on Meta. Here is how it performed against a normal auction:

STAGE	THIS AUCTION	A NORMAL AUCTION
Sign-ups	340	340
Cost per sign-up	$38	$38
Registered to bid	**22**	60
Bids placed	**4**	12

The ads dashboard looks normal. The business result does not. Answer in this order:

1. **Sketch the funnel** you'd expect for an online property auction, from ad click to winning bid.
2. **The first three things you'd check**, in priority order, and why each comes before the next.
3. **Your top hypothesis** in one sentence, plus the runner-up.
4. **How you'd confirm it** and what data you'd need.

5. **The fix**, and what it should do to registration rate.
6. **An early-warning system** so this surfaces within 48 hours next time, not after the auction.

Finish with the 5 to 6 KPIs you'd watch across the full funnel, with the conversion rate you'd treat as "healthy" at each stage and why.

PART 2

Fill the next auction 3 to 4 slides

Pick one live property from vihara.ai/auctions. Your goal is registered bidders, not sign-ups. Build a plan a media buyer could launch tomorrow:

- **Objective and optimization event.** What you'd optimize for, and why not just "Lead."
- **Budget and structure.** How much you'd spend and why, how you'd structure campaigns and ad sets, and how spend shifts across prospecting, retargeting, and the final days before auction.
- **Three buyer segments**, one creative concept each. Choose from flippers, buy-and-hold investors, first-time investors, portfolio buyers, or owner-occupants. For each: who they are, their awareness stage, the pain or desire, and the angle.
- **Copy.** Primary text, headline, and CTA for each concept.
- **Landing page.** The above-the-fold headline, subhead, proof points, and CTA. Say what you'd remove from today's page.
- **Retargeting.** Who you'd retarget, with what message, at what point before auction day.

Show real work, not descriptions. Make at least **3 finished ad creatives** (static or short video) using AI tools. Rough is fine. "A photo of the house with bold text" is not a creative.

PART 3

Your testing rules 1 slide

New properties come up for auction all the time, so creative has to be tested and replaced fast. Show us the system you'd run.

- **What you'd test first** across your Part 2 campaign, and why that variable matters most.
- **Kill, iterate, scale rules with numbers.** After what spend, at what cost per registered bidder, do you cut, tweak, or scale an ad? How much do you scale by?
- **Weekly cadence.** How many new creatives you'd ship each week, and how you decide what the next batch is.
- **How results carry over.** How a win on one property feeds the next auction instead of starting from zero.

PART 4

Buyer and partner referral program 2 slides

Our best buyers know other buyers. Investors talk to investors, and agents, wholesalers, and lenders sit on lists of active buyers. Design a referral program that turns them into an acquisition

channel that gets cheaper as it grows.

- **Who refers.** Past bidders, winning buyers, and partners such as agents, wholesalers, hard-money lenders, or property managers. Pick who you'd start with and why.
- **The reward.** What it is, and when it triggers: on registration, first bid, winning bid, or closing. Explain the trade-off you chose.
- **The mechanics.** How someone refers (link, code, form), how we track it, and how the referred buyer's experience differs.
- **Launch in 14 days.** The exact message to past buyers (email or SMS), where the program lives on the site, and the first 3 actions you'd take.
- **Quality and abuse controls.** How you stop fake or low-quality referrals.
- **Compliance flags.** What you'd check before paying referral rewards in real estate. You don't need the legal answer; we want to see you know where the risks are.
- **Success metrics.** What would make this a winner after 60 days, compared with paid Meta.

PART 5

Your AI workflow 1 slide

At Vihara, one marketer with AI should do the work of a small team. Show us how you actually work.

- **What you used.** The tools you used for this assignment and what each one did: research, segments, copy, images, video, landing page, analysis.
- **Your split.** What AI produced, what you changed, and where you overruled it. Include 2 to 3 of your real prompts.
- **Where AI got it wrong.** One output you threw away, and why.
- **One workflow to automate at Vihara.** Pick a repeated task (for example, ad variations for every new property, or a weekly performance report). Show the steps, the tools, and the hours it saves each week.

Using AI is expected. Hiding it is not.

PART 6

Your first 30 days 1 slide

One slide, four weeks. For each week, list the 2 to 3 things you'd do and the number you'd expect to move.

WEEK	SUGGESTED FOCUS
1	Audit and fix: tracking, funnel leaks, account structure
2	Launch: new creative and campaign structure
3	Test, and launch the referral program
4	Scale what works, cut what doesn't, report

If you'd order it differently, tell us why.

WHAT WE'RE LOOKING FOR

How we evaluate

AREA	WEIGHT	WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE
Execution	35%	Finished creatives and copy we could launch this week
Thinking	30%	Clear priorities, sharp hypotheses, numbers behind decisions
AI fit	20%	Real workflow, honest about what AI did, faster without losing quality
Vihara specificity	15%	Built for REO auctions and our buyers, not generic marketing

SUBMISSION

What to send us

1. **A deck of 8 to 10 slides** (PDF or link). Shorter is better if it's sharper.
2. **Your creative files** from Part 2, attached or linked.
3. **A 5-minute Loom** walking through what you prioritized and why. The deck shows your output; the video shows your thinking.

SUBMIT HERE **Vihara Assignment Submission Form**

Share all links with view access. Submit within 72 hours of receiving this assignment.

Use any tools you like. AI, design tools, the Meta Ad Library, spreadsheets. We judge the work, not the software.

Don't run ads, spend money, or contact anyone on Vihara's behalf. Use public information only.

SHOW US HOW YOU THINK

There's no single right answer. We want to see what you prioritize, what you'd test, and how fast you turn an idea into something live.

If you were already running marketing at Vihara, what would you do on Monday? That's the assignment.